

NetSuite Technical Implementation Playbook

Einbau • Approved customer journey → configured workflow → reliable dashboards

Implementation outcome: A controlled, tested NetSuite process that receives Bid Intake data, creates or updates the correct records, advances pursued bids through the approved opportunity journey, assigns follow-up, closes outcomes accurately, and powers role-specific dashboards.

How Ben should use this guide

1. Complete the current-state audit and decision log before creating fields.
2. Configure and test everything in NetSuite Sandbox. If Sandbox is unavailable, use a restricted pilot with clearly identified test records.
3. Build the minimum viable workflow first; defer convenience automations until the core record and stage logic passes testing.
4. Do not activate dashboards until test records prove that the underlying fields and stage transitions are reliable.
5. Promote to production only after business acceptance, technical sign-off, and a rollback/export plan are complete.

Implementation sequence and gates

Workstream	Primary output	Gate to proceed
1. Architecture & audit	Record model, field inventory, IDs, ownership	Every approved requirement has a system home and owner
2. NetSuite configuration	Custom lists, fields, forms, roles	Configuration reviewed in Sandbox
3. Integration & SuiteFlow	Mapped upload, stage logic, tasks, alerts	No duplicate or silent-failure path
4. Scenario testing	Passed test script and defect log	All critical scenarios pass
5. Dashboards	Saved searches, KPIs and role dashboards	Totals reconcile to source records
6. Pilot & activation	Trained users, production release, governance	Owner accepts operating responsibility

1. Lock the NetSuite Record Architecture

1.1 Recommended system-of-record model

Business object	NetSuite record	Purpose / rule
RFQ / bid intake	Custom Bid Intake record (recommended)	Retain every submitted form, including No Bid. One intake per Procore RFQ ID.
Pursued commercial bid	Standard Opportunity	Create only when Qualification Result = Pursue, unless Einbau elects to report all RFQs as opportunities.
Company	Customer / Prospect record	One account record per legal/trading entity; holds account segment and relationship history.
Person	Contact	Linked to the correct account; preserve role and email.
Estimate work	Procore	Procore remains the operational estimating source; NetSuite stores reference, commercial stage and reportable milestones.
Follow-up	Task / Phone Call / Event	Linked to Opportunity and account; owner and due date required.
Project execution	Procore + NetSuite job/project as applicable	Creation/handoff begins after award under the existing finance/operations design.

Decision Ben must record: Does the current Bid Intake Form already create a custom intake record, a NetSuite Opportunity, or both? Do not redesign until the live configuration and actual submitted records have been inspected.

1.2 Keep three statuses separate

Status	Record / field	Example values
Qualification Result	Bid Intake	Pending Review; Pursue; No Bid; Leadership Override
Estimating Status	Bid Intake or Opportunity custom field	Not Started; In Preparation; Submitted; Revision Required; Complete
Commercial Opportunity Stage	Opportunity status/stage	RFQ Imported; Qualified–Estimating; Bid Submitted; Client Evaluation; Negotiation; Awarded–Handoff; Closed Won/Lost; On Hold

These statuses must not overwrite one another. A Procore estimate can be complete while the commercial opportunity remains open and awaiting a client decision.

2. Complete the Configuration Workbook Before Building

2.1 Current-state audit — Ben

- Open several real records produced by the current form upload: pursued bid, no-bid, existing customer, new customer, and incomplete submission.
- Export or document the current field IDs, record types, form/script source, deployment, integration user, and current error behavior.
- Identify standard fields already in use and avoid creating duplicate custom fields with similar labels.
- Confirm the unique Procore RFQ/estimate identifier and whether it is stable across revisions.
- Confirm how customer/contact matching currently works and what occurs when zero or multiple matches are found.
- Confirm whether the Claude-assisted process is a SuiteScript, external API call, middleware workflow, CSV import, or another mechanism. Record where its code/configuration lives and who can maintain it.

2.2 Field dictionary required columns

Column	What to document
Business label	User-facing name approved by the team
NetSuite record	Bid Intake, Customer, Contact, Opportunity, Task, Project
Field ID	Existing or proposed script ID; use a consistent custrecord_/custbody_/custentity_ convention
Type & values	Text, list, date, currency, checkbox; approved value list
Source	Form, Procore, NetSuite default, workflow, or manual user
Required when	Creation, Pursue, Bid Submitted, Won/Lost, etc.
Owner	Role responsible for manual accuracy
Downstream use	Workflow, saved search, KPI, dashboard, audit only
Security	View/edit roles and any sensitive content
Test	Scenario and expected result

2.3 Minimum field set to configure or confirm

Record	Field / data element	Source	Required rule
Bid Intake	Procure RFQ ID / External ID	Form/Procure	Always; unique
Bid Intake	Form Submission ID and timestamp	Form	Always; immutable
Bid Intake	Qualification Result and No-Bid Reason	Form	Always; reason required for No Bid
Bid Intake	Leadership Override, approver, date	NetSuite/manual	Required only for override
Customer	Account Segment / Lifecycle	Manual or rule	Required after account review
Customer	Legal name, region, vertical, account tier	Form + review	Required for active account
Contact	Name, email, role/title, linked account	Form + match	Email or another stable match key required
Opportunity	Opportunity name / project name	Form	Required on creation
Opportunity	Procure RFQ ID link	Workflow	Required and unique per pursued RFQ
Opportunity	Stage and probability	Workflow / owner	Always on open opportunity
Opportunity	Opportunity owner and estimator	Rule/manual	Required before estimating
Opportunity	Bid due date and submitted date	Form/manual	Due date before pursue; submitted date at submission
Opportunity	Estimated/submitted value and final awarded value	Form/manual	Submitted value at Bid Submitted; final value at Won
Opportunity	Expected award/decision date	Manual	Required at Bid Submitted
Opportunity	Next action and next-action date	Manual/workflow	Required for submitted/open bids
Opportunity	Estimating Status	Integration/manual	Required for pursued bids
Opportunity	Lead/RFQ source, region, vertical, tier	Form/account	Required for reporting
Opportunity	Closed outcome reason / competitor / feedback	Manual	Reason required for Lost or No Bid
Task	Owner, due date, related opportunity, status	Workflow/manual	Required when follow-up is created

Configuration principle: Only make a field mandatory at the stage when users can reasonably know it. Creation-time mandatory fields should be minimal; stage-entry rules should enforce later information.

3. Configure NetSuite in Sandbox

3.1 Create controlled lists first

- Create or clean the custom lists for Account Segment, Qualification Result, Estimating Status, No-Bid Reason, Lost Reason, Region, Vertical, Opportunity Tier and Lead/RFQ Source.
- Retire duplicate or obsolete values; do not delete values used historically. Mark inactive where appropriate.
- Define display order and descriptions so users interpret each value consistently.
- Map old values to new values before any import or migration.

3.2 Configure fields and forms

- Create only the fields approved in the field dictionary, using stable script IDs and descriptions.
- Add fields to the correct preferred Opportunity, Customer, Contact and Bid Intake forms. Group them into logical subtabs: Intake & Qualification; Estimating; Commercial Follow-Up; Outcome; Integration Audit.
- Set role-based display: hide technical integration fields from ordinary users; expose outcome and next-action fields to responsible roles.
- Use validation and stage-entry workflows for conditional requirements; avoid making every field globally mandatory.
- Add system notes/audit visibility for material stage, value, owner and outcome changes.

3.3 Configure opportunity stages and probabilities

Approved stage	Entry trigger	Minimum data before entry	Suggested probability*
RFQ Imported – Review Required	Form upload creates/links record	Procure RFQ ID; account; project; qualification result	0–5%
Qualified – Estimating	Qualification = Pursue	Owner; estimator; deadline; tier	10%
Bid in Preparation	Estimator starts work	Estimating status; next milestone	15%
Bid Submitted	Submission confirmed	Submitted date/value; decision date; follow-up owner/date	25%
Client Evaluation / Follow-Up	Client reviewing	Next action and date	35%
Clarification / Negotiation	Active commercial discussion	Current value; issue/next action	60%
Awarded – Handoff Pending	Verbal/written award	Expected/final value; handoff owner	90%
Closed Won	Commercial and operating handoff complete	Final value; award date; project link	100%
Closed Lost	Client awards elsewhere / cancels after bid	Lost reason; decision date	0%
On Hold	Confirmed delay	Hold reason; review date	Retain prior or 0% per policy

*Probabilities are configuration starting points, not validated Einbau forecasting assumptions. Leadership should approve them or replace them with probabilities calculated from historical conversion data.

4. Formalize the Form-to-NetSuite Integration

4.1 Required integration control flow

15. Receive the Bid Intake submission and assign/retain a unique Form Submission ID.
16. Validate required source fields and allowed values before writing to NetSuite.
17. Search for an existing Bid Intake using Procure RFQ ID or the approved external key. Update the existing intake for a revision; do not create a second record.
18. Match the account using the approved hierarchy (for example: NetSuite internal/external ID, normalized legal name plus location, or reviewed domain). Do not match on company name alone without ambiguity handling.
19. Match the contact using account plus normalized email. If no safe match exists, create a review queue item rather than silently linking to an uncertain contact.
20. Upsert the Bid Intake record and retain raw submission reference, processed timestamp, integration version and processing status.
21. If Qualification = Pursue, create or update the linked Opportunity. If No Bid, retain and report the intake without activating a pursued opportunity, subject to the architecture decision.
22. Set the initial Opportunity stage and copy only approved fields. Do not overwrite user-maintained fields with blanks or stale source data.
23. Write the NetSuite internal IDs back to the integration log/source where technically possible.
24. On failure, log the payload reference, record/key, step, error, retry status and owner; notify the integration owner.

4.2 Duplicate and revision rules

Condition	Required behavior
Same Procure RFQ ID submitted again	Update the same intake; preserve submission/revision history.
Same RFQ ID, pursued opportunity exists	Update permitted source fields; never create another opportunity.
Customer match is unique	Link existing Customer/Prospect.
No customer match	Create Prospect only if minimum identity rules pass; otherwise route to review.
Multiple customer matches	Stop automatic linking and create an exception.

Condition	Required behavior
Contact email already exists under another account	Route to review; do not silently relink.
Blank value in new submission	Do not erase an existing value unless the field mapping explicitly allows clearing.
Integration unavailable	Queue/retry safely; expose failures on an exception saved search.

4.3 Technical documentation Ben must produce

- Integration diagram and system boundaries.
- Endpoint/authentication method and least-privilege integration role.
- Source-to-target field map with transformation rules.
- Unique key, upsert and revision rules.
- Error log location, alert recipient, retry process and reconciliation method.
- Deployment/code location, version history and recovery instructions.
- Daily or weekly reconciliation count: submitted forms vs. successful NetSuite writes vs. exceptions.

5. Build the NetSuite Workflow (SuiteFlow / SuiteScript as Needed)

Design rule: Use SuiteFlow for transparent field-setting, validation, tasks and alerts. Use SuiteScript only where matching, upsert, complex validation or integration behavior cannot be implemented safely in SuiteFlow.

5.1 Workflow A — Intake validation and routing

Trigger / state	System action	Exception / owner
Bid Intake created or updated	Validate external ID, account, qualification and required source fields	Missing/invalid → Integration Exception queue; Ben during launch
Qualification = No Bid	Require No-Bid Reason; mark intake closed/no-bid; do not create pursued opportunity	Missing reason → block or return for correction
Qualification = Pursue	Create/link Opportunity; set initial stage; assign default owner rules	No safe account/contact → review queue
Leadership Override	Require approver/date/reason; retain original result	Missing approval → do not proceed

5.2 Workflow B — Opportunity stage controls

Transition	Required validations / actions
Imported → Qualified	Owner, estimator, bid deadline, priority/tier and Procore RFQ ID present.
Qualified → Bid in Preparation	Estimating Status updated; assigned estimator notified if needed.
Any open → Bid Submitted	Submitted date and value, expected decision date, follow-up owner and next-action date required; create follow-up task.
Submitted → Evaluation	Maintain open task and next action; flag overdue action/date.
Evaluation → Negotiation	Require current value and next action; optionally notify leadership for strategic tier.
Any open → On Hold	Require hold reason and review date; create review task.
Any open → Closed Won	Require final value, award date and handoff confirmation/project reference.

Transition	Required validations / actions
Any submitted → Closed Lost	Require lost reason and decision date; close/cancel outstanding follow-up tasks.

5.3 Workflow C — Follow-up, stale records and data quality

- At Bid Submitted, create a linked follow-up task using the separately approved operating model. Do not hard-code ownership until Devid/Brian validation is complete.
- Daily scheduled workflow: flag open submitted opportunities with overdue next-action dates.
- Daily scheduled workflow: flag open opportunities with no owner, no next action, missing value or past expected decision date.
- On stage change to Closed Won/Lost, close remaining open follow-up tasks and stamp closed date.
- Notify the record owner first; escalate only after the approved grace period to avoid alert fatigue.
- Expose all workflow exceptions through saved searches instead of relying only on email alerts.

6. Test the Workflow End to End

6.1 Test preparation

25. Create a test-data naming convention such as TEST-EINBAU-[scenario]-[date].
26. Clone production roles/permissions in Sandbox and test as each actual user role—not only Administrator.
27. Record the expected result before executing each scenario.
28. Capture evidence: source submission ID, NetSuite internal IDs, screenshots/export, task IDs and dashboard results.
29. Log each defect with severity, owner, fix and retest result.

6.2 Minimum test matrix

#	Scenario	Expected result
T01	Pursue; existing account/contact	One intake and one linked opportunity; correct fields/stage/owners.
T02	Pursue; new valid account/contact	Prospect/contact created or routed per policy; opportunity linked.
T03	No Bid	Intake retained; reason recorded; no pursued opportunity created.
T04	Same RFQ resubmitted/revised	Existing intake/opportunity updated; no duplicate; history retained.
T05	Multiple possible customer matches	Automatic processing stops; exception created.
T06	Missing required intake data	No partial/incorrect opportunity; actionable error visible.
T07	Bid Submitted transition	Required fields enforced; follow-up task created and linked.
T08	On Hold	Reason/review date required; review task created.
T09	Closed Won	Final value/date/handoff required; open follow-ups closed.
T10	Closed Lost	Lost reason/date required; dashboards update correctly.
T11	Integration/API failure	Failure logged, alert/queue created, safe retry does not duplicate.
T12	Role security	Each user can view/edit only intended fields and records.
T13	Dashboard reconciliation	Saved-search counts and sums match the test records.
T14	Blank/stale resubmission	Existing user-maintained values are not erased improperly.

6.3 Acceptance thresholds

- 100% pass for duplicate prevention, record matching, stage-entry controls, security, Closed Won/Lost and integration-failure handling.
- No unresolved Severity 1 or 2 defects before pilot.
- Dashboard counts and currency totals reconcile exactly to the approved source searches.
- Business users can complete assigned tasks without Administrator access.
- Every exception has a visible owner and recovery path.

7. Build and Validate the Dashboards

7.1 Build saved searches before dashboard tiles

30. Create one governed saved search for each KPI or operational list; dashboards should display those controlled sources.
31. Define the population, date basis, amount field, stage inclusion/exclusion, and currency treatment for every KPI.
32. Name consistently: EIN – [Function] – [Metric] – [Detail/Summary].
33. Set audience and permissions by role; protect definitions from casual edits.
34. Reconcile each search to a controlled test dataset before adding it to dashboards.

7.2 Dashboard build specification

Dashboard	Core saved searches / KPIs	Validator & review rhythm
Executive	Open and weighted pipeline; pipeline by stage; expected awards/start dates; win rate; bid vs. awarded value; outcome reasons; region/vertical/tier	Leadership stakeholder; weekly pipeline, monthly performance
Estimating	Qualified bids awaiting assignment; bids by estimator; approaching/overdue deadlines; workload; submitted bids awaiting follow-up; win rate cuts	Estimating lead/team; daily workload, weekly review
Follow-Up / BD	Submitted bids due/overdue for follow-up; expected decisions; missing next actions; engaged prospects; dormant/repeat opportunities	Approved process owner after David/Brian sign-off; daily/weekly
Data Quality	Missing owner/value/ID/next action; past decision dates; duplicates; integration exceptions; closed records without reasons	Each stakeholder corrects owned records; designated system steward monitors weekly

7.3 Metric definitions that must be approved

Metric	Recommended definition
Bid win rate	Closed Won pursued bids ÷ (Closed Won + Closed Lost pursued bids). Exclude No Bid and unresolved open bids.
Bid value win rate	Closed Won final/submitted value ÷ total decided submitted value, using one agreed value basis.
Open pipeline	Open pursued opportunities only; exclude No Bid, Lost, Won and optionally On Hold.
Weighted pipeline	Current opportunity amount × approved stage probability.
Follow-up overdue	Open opportunity where next-action date is before today and the related action is incomplete.
Estimator win rate	Won ÷ decided submitted bids assigned to estimator; confirm attribution and minimum sample size.

Dashboard activation gate: A dashboard is not approved because it looks correct. Its saved-search population, formula, filters and totals must reconcile to known records and be accepted by the people who will use it.

8. Pilot, Production Release and Governance

8.1 Pilot release

35. Select a limited set of new RFQs and a small user group representing Estimating, follow-up/CRM and leadership.
36. Run the process for at least one qualified bid, one no-bid and one submitted/closed outcome.
37. Hold a short review: errors, unnecessary manual work, unclear field labels, missed alerts and dashboard discrepancies.
38. Fix, retest and freeze the release candidate.

8.2 Production cutover checklist

- Export configuration/workflow/script versions and document the rollback method.
- Schedule a low-volume release window and communicate the short change freeze.
- Deploy custom lists, fields, forms, scripts/workflows, saved searches and dashboards in dependency order.

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- Confirm script/workflow deployments, audiences, roles, scheduled workflows and integration credentials.
- Run smoke tests using controlled production records; remove or clearly close test records afterward.
- Reconcile the first production submissions to the source and resolve exceptions immediately.
- Announce activation, user responsibilities, support contact and review cadence.

8.3 Ongoing governance

Control	Owner	Cadence / evidence
Form vs. NetSuite reconciliation	Integration/system owner	Daily during launch; weekly thereafter; submission/write/exception counts
Opportunity data quality	Each stakeholder for owned records; steward monitors	Weekly exception saved search
Pipeline and follow-up review	Department/dashboard owner	Weekly meeting using live dashboard
Win/loss and qualification analysis	Leadership + business process owner	Monthly
Workflow/configuration changes	Ben / authorized NetSuite administrator	Change request, Sandbox test, version note, approval
Dashboard definition changes	Dashboard owner + NetSuite administrator	Documented metric definition and acceptance test
Role/access review	NetSuite administrator + leadership	Quarterly or on staffing changes

9. Ben's Immediate Working Plan

Order	Action	Deliverable / completion evidence
1	Demonstrate the current form upload live using real examples	Screenshots/record IDs showing pursued, no-bid, new/existing account and error behavior.
2	Complete record and field inventory	Current-state field list with record, ID, source, use and gaps.
3	Confirm intake-versus-opportunity architecture	Written decision approved by Diana/business owner and Ben.
4	Complete source-to-target mapping and matching rules	Signed field map, unique keys, upsert rules and exception paths.
5	Configure controlled lists, fields and forms in Sandbox	Configuration review completed.
6	Formalize the upload/integration controls	Documented owner, auth, logs, retry and reconciliation.
7	Build SuiteFlow stage controls and tasks	Workflow diagram/state list plus successful unit tests.
8	Execute the test matrix	Test log with evidence; critical defects closed.
9	Build saved searches and dashboards	Reconciled metrics; stakeholder acceptance.
10	Pilot and deploy	Pilot sign-off, cutover checklist, production smoke test.
11	Transfer operations	Short SOP, role training, governance cadence and support owner.

First meeting objective: Ben and Diana should not leave the first technical working session with a general discussion. They should leave with: (1) the chosen record architecture, (2) a completed current-state field inventory or named gaps, (3) approved matching/unique-key rules, (4) an agreed MVP automation scope, and (5) dated build and test milestones.

10. Technical Decision Log

Decision	Recommended position	Final decision / owner / date
No-bid record treatment	Retain all Bid Intakes; create/activate Opportunity only for Pursue.	

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Decision	Recommended position	Final decision / owner / date
Unique integration key	Use stable Procore RFQ ID; retain submission/revision ID separately.	
Customer match rule	Use a reviewed hierarchy; ambiguous matches go to exception queue.	
Contact match rule	Account + normalized email; conflicts require review.	
Blank overwrite behavior	Do not overwrite populated NetSuite values with blanks by default.	
Follow-up owner/rules	Insert only after Devid refines and Brian validates operating model.	
Stage probabilities	Approve starting assumptions or calculate from history.	
Integration owner	Name one technical owner and one business owner.	
Data-quality steward	Stakeholders correct owned data; name one monitoring/escalation steward.	
Production release approver	Name business approver and NetSuite technical approver.	